CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 14: **The Elephant and the Tragopan** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The most suitable alternative title for the poem is: 1

(a) A Day at the Dam **(b)** The Trout's Triumph
(c) Friends of the Road **(d)** Whose Home Is It?

2. The word 'homeless' is formed by adding the suffix: 1

(a) -ful **(b)** -ly **(c)** -less **(d)** -ness

3. The poem uses the idea of a 'fief' to criticise: 1

(a) the attitude of ownership towards nature **(b)** bird watching
(c) the love of the countryside **(d)** farming alone

4. The word 'homeless' in the poem's closing line gains force because it: 1

(a) applies only to fish **(b)** is used jokingly
(c) includes the speaker as well **(d)** refers to humans

5. In the sentence 'The trout was delighted with the extra space', 'delighted' is closest to: 1

(a) puzzled **(b)** very pleased **(c)** sleepy **(d)** upset

6. Why does the elephant correct the trout rather than simply ignore it? 1

(a) because he is bored
(b) because he dislikes the trout
(c) because he wants the reservoir
(d) because he wants every creature to see the wider danger

7. Why might the poet have chosen a tragopan and not a commoner bird? 1

(a) because it is easily seen
(b) because it hates elephants
(c) because it eats fish
(d) to point to rarer forest creatures threatened by habitat loss

8. Which of the following is an example of a short-sighted act, as seen in the poem? 1

(a) saving water
(b) planting trees
(c) protecting a nest
(d) welcoming a project without thinking of its effects

9. Which statement best captures the irony of the trout's joy? 1

(a) It rejoices in what will ruin the whole valley, including itself
(b) It is not affected
(c) It is the only wise animal
(d) It is rewarded by humans

10. Which pair shows a correct cause and effect from the poem? 1

(a) reservoir built -> bamboo destroyed **(b)** tragopan sings -> dam breaks
(c) trout speaks -> forest returns **(d)** bamboo grows -> road built

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Suggest an alternative title and justify it. 2

12. Why might the poet end without a stated moral? 2

13. Explain how the metaphor of a 'fief' criticises humans. 2

14. How does the poem balance criticism and hope? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss the line 'When the road comes, the forest goes' as a cause-effect statement. 3

16. Why is the poem still relevant today? 3

17. Predict what might happen to the valley after the reservoir. 3

OR

Evaluate the elephant as the poet's spokesperson. 3

18. Write a short note on the tone shifts in the poem. 3

OR

Why is the elephant's last statement powerful? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a speech for a school assembly on 'Development with Care for Nature', using the poem. 5

OR

Write a letter to a newspaper opposing the clearing of a forest for a dam, using ideas from the poem. 5

20. Write a news report of the animals' meeting in the valley. 5

OR

What lessons about progress and responsibility does the poem give? 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks